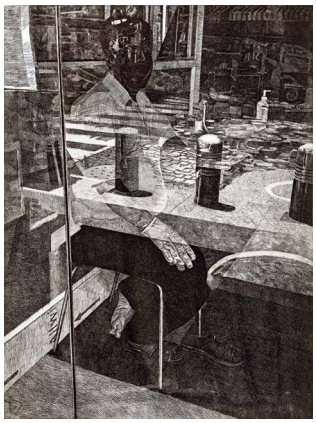




FOR THE AGES
1) 'Download from Life' (lithograph) by Sushanta Guha
2) M.F. Husain's untitled lithograph
3) Raja Ravi Varma's untitled oleograph
4) 'Lockdown Reflection I' (intaglio) by Dattatraya Apte



art form," Puri said. "Like with photography, the fact that these people are creating original art is not very well-understood, even today." To that extent, these words from Paula Sengupta's *Printed Picture* (Delhi Art Gallery, 2012) are displayed right at the entrance of the exhibition.

"The artist is usually completely or largely involved in the platemaking and printing process in all printmaking mediums. Once the matrix is prepared, it goes through a process of proofing until the artist is satisfied. Once satisfied, a limited edition is printed from the matrix. Each proof and edition print numbered and signed by the artist is an original work of art, and must be treated and valued as such."

Of *Divergent Practices* is a great entry point to the practice and promise of printmaking. And if you're already an aficionado, you'll find plenty to appreciate and admire. ■

Aditya Mani Jha

OH MY GOGH!

The immersive and emotional experience called ***VAN GOGH 360°*** brings the Dutch artist's works to life in unexpected ways

High art, we believe, usually stems from the deliciously happy or the deliriously sad. Anyone familiar with the story of Dutch artist Vincent Van Gogh (or, at any rate, has heard the Don McLean song 'Vincent') will know about his life that teetered between sadness and (what was then known as) madness, both of which fuelled a creative frenzy that resulted in 2,100 works of art in just 10 years.

So, when *Van Gogh 360° India*, "an immersive, multimedia event", arrives in our city, we know we want to see how the work of the 19th-century artist has been transformed into something that appeals to 21st-century sensibilities. We book a slot and line up, all set to be impressed by the post-Impressionist painter.

The first section provides insights into Van Gogh's life and the people and places that impacted it. While it's information that's easily available online, the presentation of it is on point. The second part, which involves a pastiche of his work projected on the floors and walls of a large hall, allows us to feel we are connecting with his brilliance. The technological wizardry is undeniable and incredible, bringing aspects of more than 300 of his artworks to life in unexpected ways.

We are held in thrall by it all—the almost-surreal beauty of his most popular creations like 'The Starry Night' and 'Sunflowers', the intentional ugliness of the peasants in 'The Potato Eaters' (which he believed was his best work), and the possibly prophetic 'Wheatfield with Crows', which bears an uncanny resemblance to the scene of his death. This multi-dimensional universe that highlights each brushstroke moves us deeply as much as it exhilarates us. We understand why many of his portraits bore a green tinge, his complex and difficult relationships with those closest to him, how his mental health and bipolar mind that led him to cut off an ear never allowed him the peace to enjoy his own paintings the way we can with this exhibit today.

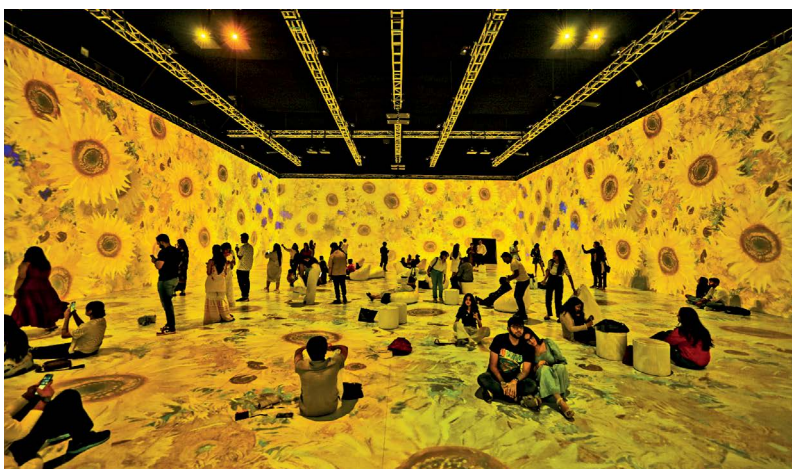
> The multimedia event transforms **VAN GOGH'S** work into something that appeals to 21st-century sensibilities

With similar experiences around the world from New York to London to Tokyo to Toronto, and a sold-out run in Mumbai, Delhi's glitterati are understandably excited. For many, it is just great fodder for the 'gram. Nevertheless, whether it's one's soul or selfie that is illuminated by *Van Gogh 360°*, and though it may not be as elaborate as the one that can be seen in Amsterdam, it's certainly something worth checking out. ■

Priya Pathiyan

(Van Gogh 360° India is showing at DLF Cyber City, Gurugram, till April 30. It will travel to Bengaluru, Chennai, Ahmedabad, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Jaipur, Kochi, Chandigarh, Bhopal, Lucknow, Nagpur, Pune, Indore, Goa and Surat later this year)

ALL AGOG(H) The *Van Gogh 360° India* exhibition in Gurugram



SHREY GUPTA